Spotlight on Interview Types

A. Match the types of interviews in the box with the correct definitions below.

a. One-on-one interview	e. Case interviews
b. Group interview	f. Mealtime interview
c. Panel interview	g. Presentations
d. Behavioral interview	h. Distance interview

1. One-on-one One of the most common types of interview. The applicant is interviewed by a repres of the organization.

2. Panel An interview where a small group of interviewers from the same or different departm present and may ask questions. Academic interviews are generally held in this way.

3. Behavioral An interview aiming to predict an applicant's potential performance /competence fr of what he or she has done in the past. In this type of interview, rather than questions about hypothetical s candidates are asked to talk about real past experience. A sample question is: "Can you tell me about a tim you failed to accomplish a task?"

4. Group A speedy and efficient way to screen large numbers of applicants for the same posit The interviewer aims to see how the candidate interacts with other candidates and what role he takes am Candidates are asked to work on a task together.

5. Distance Preferred when the candidate is not a local. This type of interview is usually pre-sch is conducted via telephone, conference call or online audio/video service.

6. Mealtime In this type of interview, some other members of the department are also invited t candidate may fit in. The interview is held in a less formal conversational atmosphere where the applican questions. Good table manners will definitely be an advantage for the candidate.

7. Presentations Intends to measure how well the candidate can gather his/her thoughts, plan, pre communicate with an audience. Interviewees are expected to provide clear substantial information with introduction and an effective ending usually within 5 or 10 minutes.

8. Case interview The applicant is given a real or a hypothetical question, problem, or a challenge a expected to resolve it, either individually or in a group. The aim is to see the thought processes, the anal and problem solving skills of the applicant while s/he is trying to come up with a solution to the issue at whether s/he can apply his/her academic and professional knowledge. The problem is usually presente information to force the applicant to ask relevant questions for clarification or make some assumptions. be one or more evaluators observing the process.

B. Match the examples with the types of interviews listed in exercise A.

1. Case interview Hamid Tariq is a Business Administration major. He is looking to become an Inve and has applied to YK Bank for their trainee program. The recruiter and several other interviewers co the sides silently observing. The recruiter explains the situation, presents the problem and asks for so of the issue, including explanations of the interviewees' reasoning and assumptions they make as the a solution or a recommendation.

2. Group interview Terence Atkinson has applied to Inca Engineering to become a project engineer at their hydroelectric power plant building site in New Jersey. At the headquarters of the company in Chicago, the secretary in the human resources department directs him to the meeting room upstairs where five other candidates are waiting. They are asked to interview each other and then introduce their partner to the others in the room. Once that is done, the recruiter divides them into two teams and asks them to build a house of cards in the shortest time with the given specifications. When the task is done, the recruiter takes each candidate aside and asks to evaluate the performance of their group and make suggestions.

3. Real-time interview Rotunda Williams, a PhD student of the Geology Department at ADA University, is about to finish her degree. She hopes her credentials and experience as teaching assistant will get her a teaching position at the local university in her hometown. About a month after her application she is called for a face-to-face interview, all expenses paid. Next month, Rotunda is received by the department head and several of his colleagues from the department. After introductions and a brief questioning the group takes her out to a local restaurant. Rotunda finds the opportunity to get to know her prospective colleagues better over lunch.

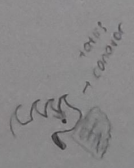
4. Presentation Geeta Pavil has been contacted by the recruitment officer from P&J Advertising for a final interview. She is given a problem and asked to be prepared to present her recommendations on how to tackle the issue in about 5-7 minutes the next morning. Geeta prepares her answers on Prezi and practices with her sister several times before going in for the interview.

5. Behavioral Janet Weiland wants to be a customer services clerk at the Richmond branch of Carrington Office Supply Stores. She has been called for an interview. At the company offices, after some small talk, Janet is asked to draw on her experience working as the student council president at her school and to talk about a specific incident where she successfully solved a problem using her people skills.

6. Distance Loki Thorndyke has applied to a Physics Master's program in another country. Two weeks after sending his application documents, he receives an email indicating that he will be interviewed sometime on the Tuesday of the following week. On the day, at 10:15 am, his phone rings. It is Christine Oberman, the department head. She asks if he has time to answer a few questions. He is asked about his educational background, motivation and future plans.

7. Panel Aimee Covington is about to finish her Master's Degree in teaching. She plans to continue with a PhD. She has applied to several top schools and has been invited for an interview at Ivy College's Department of Education. She is greeted by the department chair and taken to the seminar room where two other professors are waiting. For the next 40 minutes, a conversation ensues. She is asked about her education and why she wants to pursue an academic career. The professors want to particularly find out about her field of interest and what practical experience she has in the field.

8. One-on-one Roger Waters has applied to Acme Co for a chemist internship. He has been called for an interview. On the day of the interview, Mr. Johnson, the hiring manager, greets him in the waiting room where other candidates are waiting and invites him into his office. He is asked questions concerning information on his CV such as his background and experience. Mr. Johnson also asks Roger about his strengths and weaknesses, and whether he plans to stay on with Acme Co if he is hired. At the end, Mr. Johnson bids goodbye and tells him when the decision will be made.



Spotlight on Common Interview Questions:

A. Below you will see some common interview questions with three short responses provided for each. Circle the best answer.

Question 1: Give us some background information about yourself.

a. What exactly would you like me to cover?

b. I was born in İzmir. I finished high school there and then went to İstanbul to study statistics. Then I successfully graduated with honors and I applied for a position here at your company.

c. I studied statistics at Istanbul University and I've done three internships in reputable companies where I had the opportunity to improve some skills, such as teamwork, time management and organizational skills.

Question 2: Why do you want to work for us?

a. A friend of mine suggested your company. I heard you offer a good salary and fringe benefits.

b. I researched your company and realized your projects and work style suit me well.

c. Because I completed my internship in your company and it was a good experience.

Question 3: You don't seem to have much experience. Why should we hire you?

a. I am a new graduate with much energy and enthusiasm to take on new assignments. I'm a quick learner and I adapt easily to new situations.

b. It will be to your benefit to hire me instead of hiring more senior staff because I can stay with you for longer. I have many good skills.

c. Well, it is up to you of course. The job advertisement did not say that you were looking for some years of experience.

Question 4: How do you work with others?

a. So far, I have completed my teamwork assignments successfully. I think this is due to my personality and my organizational skills.

b. If I am assigned to work with people I get along with, there is no problem.

c. Although I prefer to work on my own, I think I can manage working with others because I have good time management skills.

Question 5: What do you think of our website?

a. It looks good.

b. Unfortunately I didn't have time to examine your website.

c. It's easy to navigate. I was able to access all the information I needed about this department under the "Departments" link.

Question 6: What kind of a workplace would you like to work in?

a. I don't have any work experience so I am not sure what I am looking for.

b. A friendly environment where I can work in harmony with others and grow professionally.

c. Getting the job is important to me. I can work in any kind of workplace.

Question 7: What questions would you be asking if you were in my place?

a. Actually, you asked most of the questions that I'd ask. I think I might have asked 'In what ways have you developed over the past 5 years?'

b. You are the boss and I think you know what to ask better than I do.

c. That's a tough question. Well, I am sorry, I cannot think of any at the moment.

Question 8: How do your hobbies and interests contribute to your professional development?

a. Hobbies are important in one's life. When you have a hobby, you become more energetic and that contributes to success in your profession.

b. I have a lot of hobbies. One of them is playing the guitar. I like playing it as much as I like my field of study.

c. Through each activity I improve certain skills. To illustrate, playing chess helps me think more analytically and plan my future better.

Question 9: How do you follow the developments in your field?

a. I have subscribed to the ABC professional journal, the articles in which I follow regularly. Moreover, the Internet is a huge resource.

b. I attended all my classes regularly and learned a lot about the latest developments in my field.

c. Through the Internet.

Question 10: Do you have any questions?

a. Well, no, thanks.

b. How about the salary? We never talked about it.

c. What will be expected of me in a regular work day if I am hired?

Listening Popular Interview Questions (Track 5)

First close your books and listen to the podcast on popular interview questions.

Now, open your books and read the questions below. Then, listen for a second time and decide whether the statements below are True (T) or False (F).

Popular interview questions - Introduction

F a. You will definitely be asked some of the popular interview questions.
T b. You should take advantage of the questions to highlight your skills.
T c. One can increase his/her chances through effective body language.

Question 1: Tell me about yourself.

F a. This question is used as an icebreaker only.
T b. This is a difficult question because it requires summarizing skills.
T c. You may answer this questions in a variety of ways. The focus should be on how well you fit in with the company/institution.

Question 2: Why do you want to work in this industry?

T a. To answer this question effectively, you should do research in advance.
F b. For this question, you should focus on experiences only.

Question 3: Why do you want to work here?

T a. It's employers' common complaint that the applicants do not know enough about the company/job/organization.
T b. It is important to mention how you can contribute to the organization as you answer this question.

Question 4: What are your strengths?

T a. You should highlight the strengths that match the company mission and vision.
T b. "Strengths" refer mainly to skills.

Questions 5: What are your weaknesses?

T a. It is okay to discuss a weakness that is not going to stop you from doing your job.
F b. Interviewers ask this to make you feel bad.
T c. Focus on how you are trying to improve yourself with regard to your weakness.

Question 6: What are your career goals?

T a. Whether you have specific goals or not, you should talk about what skills and knowhow you plan to acquire.
F b. You should have a specific goal.

Question 7: What are your extracurricular activities?

F a. Extracurricular activities are a sign that you are distracted, don't mention any.
T b. You can talk about those skills and knowledge that your extracurricular activities may help you with on the job.
T c. Playing group sports may be an indication of teamwork skills.

Question 8: Describe a difficult situation you have been through.

F a. You should speak about what can be done in such difficult situations in general.
T b. Don't say anything negative about people you have worked with or your institution.
T c. The interviewer wants to know about how you deal with difficult situations.

Question 9: Do you have any questions for me?

T a. You should always prepare a couple of questions to ask.
T b. Don't ask about things like pay or holidays in the interview even if your decision to work there depends on that information.



Role Play Interview 1

You will be roleplaying an interview session. Get into groups of three or four. Choose one person to be the interviewee. The rest will be interviewers. Study the instructions on your role card and prepare accordingly.

Interviewers: go to page 162 to see your role cards. The interviewee: see page 167 for your role card.

rapport

Listening: Making a Great First Impression (Track 6)

Patrick Jane and Teresa Lisbon talk about first impressions during a job interview. Listen to the conversation and take notes in the chart below.

Approachability	most imparten confidence relax well comin friendly
Smile	good smile
Eye contact	- stare unblinkly look in the eye - interested
Handshake	firm genterfree weaker handshake palm down handshake? cold sweaty eye contact
Fidget signals	nervous voice twiring jewelery talking too much *posture get to the point looking watch keep in control chin in head leaning leg clothing nervous over nodding hand in pocket
Positive signals	energy feet flat on the flor to to casual
Non-verbal clues	body language calm others

A. Using your notes, answer the following questions.

1. Why is it important to look approachable?

because it will make easier to people talk with you.

2. How much smiling should take place?

3. What is a positive consequence of good eye-contact?

4. What is an offensive way of handshaking?

chaeng its strenght for gender

5. What do interviewers notice in a handshake?

good eye contact and being confident

6. What are fidget signals an indication of?

that you're nervais

7. When a person puts their chin in their hand, it's a signal of listening. Similarly, when people lean forward or lean in, it's a signal indicating that you're involeing

8. What's an advantage of calm composure in interviews? Explain.

B. Using your notes, write down tips for each category. The first one is done for you.

1. Be approachable and look friendly
2. Smile in good amount (genuine smile)
3. Don't stare
4. firm handshake (gender free)
5.
6.
7.
8.

TIPS

- Remember that you are also interviewing the company/institution to see if you really want to work for them/study there.
- Recruiters look for the most enthusiastic person for the job/position/program because they will bring the most commitment to it.
- Employers look for three main traits when interviewing a candidate: positivity, sense of responsibility and competency.
- The interviewer is looking for someone to recruit/accept. Every time an interviewee walks in, they hope it's going to be the right one. So, let that be you.

Spotlight on Common Examples of Misconduct at the Workplace

Match the cases below with the type(s) of workplace ethics violation from the box. The cases may involve multiple violations.

fabrication	sexual harassment	employer intimidation	conflict of interest	plagiarism
stealing	academic misconduct	time theft	discriminatory practices	

fabrication — a. Changing time sheets to cover up late arrivals or early departures.

stealing — b. Taking some office supplies like pencils, paper, staples or highlighters home thinking that you need them there while working on the company project.

Employer intimidation — c. Using a language that would hurt the feelings and undermine the self-confidence of a subordinate

time theft — d. Calling in sick to go have a nice day out.

plagiarism — e. Submitting a report where one appears to be the only owner of the product or results although s/he has worked with others in the project or has borrowed ideas or information from other sources.

time theft — f. Spending a lot of time making loud and distracting personal phone calls in the office about things that are obviously trivial.

conflict of interest — g. Privately tutoring someone who is enrolled in your class at the institution where you work.

Spotlight on Ethics at the Workplace - Victimless Crimes

Groupwork.

STEP 1: Read the following text and answer the questions in groups.

Landon has been working at a restaurant for one month. He is planning to work there for another two months before going to a holiday resort for the summer to find a better-paid job. The assistant manager, Susan, has been really nice to Landon since his first day on the job. She was very patient with him, showing him how to perform the same tasks several times, and she never got angry when he asked her the same questions again and again. Also, when Landon needed to look after his little sister, she always arranged his schedule to give him the time off. Susan is a 30-year-old single-mother of two preschool children. She is a high school graduate and has been working at the restaurant for three years. She is hoping to get into the management training program in the fall. This would mean that she could manage her own store. On her salary as assistant manager, she sometimes has trouble making ends meet. Several times over the last month, Landon has worked with Susan until closing. The manager, Mr.Sparks, either had a day off or he had left earlier. On those occasions, Landon witnessed Susan putting various food items, such as frozen hamburgers, chicken wings, tomatoes, and cucumbers, into the trunk of her car. Once he asked her about what he had seen. She told him that she needed this food to feed her children.

1. Should Landon tell Mr. Sparks what Susan is doing?
2. If Landon tells Mr. Sparks, what outcomes can he expect? Is it likely that he loses his job?
3. What if Susan claims that Landon is lying and puts the blame on him?
4. What is the best thing for Landon to do?

STEP 2: Compare your answers with other groups in a classroom discussion. As you discuss, use the language in the Expressions for Discussion box on page 240 in Appendix for Unit 4.

1. **a.** Choose one of the items from the Examples of Corrupt Practices list above. Find a news item that describes such a case in which details are given as to

   - who was involved,
   - how the issue was made public
   - what legal action was taken

   b. Prepare a 5-7 minute presentation to communicate your findings to the class. You may also include in the presentation your personal views.

2. Think about ethical violations/dilemmas you are likely to face in your chosen career in the future. Prepare a 2-3 minute presentation on the two most challenging ethical dilemmas you think you are likely to face in your career. Explain each possible scenario, why it is challenging and what you think you would do in each situation.

Many countries in the world suffer from corruption and corrupt practices. Due to the negative effects of corruption as well as its being a main obstacle to economic development, they have joined anti-corruption programs which aim at creating a culture of ethical conduct in their societies.

Let us see how the issue of corruption is addressed in the international arena.

Listening: Fighting Corruption (Track 7)

Sayfa 188

You will listen to a radio program where the speakers from the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) talk about the global issue of corruption and the initiative they have taken to fight it. First look at the questions below, then listen to the recording and answer the questions.

1. What has the OECD done to help the global fight against corruption so far?

2. Why is it difficult to deal with corruption?

3. Fill in the blanks to indicate the practices that facilitate corruption

   a. .....

   b. .....

   c. illegal funneling of funds abroad

   d. holes or ..... in the global set of rules and regulations

4. Who does corruption negatively affect the most? What about the rest, how do they handle corruption?

5. What does the new initiative launched by the OECD involve?

6. What is the main problem the OECD faces regarding the instruments that are used in the fight against corruption?

questions for clarification instead of assuming. People are usually happy to help someone who is willing to learn their ways. For example, you might want to ask your Turkish host "would you like me to take off my shoes?" before entering their house or when you're inviting someone to dinner, "Jane, you do eat meat, don't you?" But there will also be occasions where you'll need to be proficient in the culture and the rules, especially if your job requires it.

Let's learn about how to put distance between the speaker and the listener. See the table below for differences between formal and informal spoken interaction.

Informal vs. Formal Language

Informal	Formal
Use the passive voice.	
The train is late.	The train **has been delayed**.
Yesterday, the teachers' union and the school board signed an agreement to increase wages by 3%.	An agreement **was signed** (by the union and the school board) yesterday to increase teachers' wages by 3%.
My partner and I collected the data for this project over three months.	The data **was collected** over a period of three months.
The human resources team hired 3 new engineers for the project.	Three new engineers **have been hired** for the project.
Use the modals could / would / may instead of can or will.	
Open the window, please.	**Would you** open the window for me, please?
Can you hand me the book?	**Could you** hand me the book?
Can I borrow your copy of the agreement?	**May I** borrow your copy of the agreement for a moment?
Use indirect questions	
Do this.	**Would it be (at all) possible (for me/you) to** do something?
Do you want (me) to do something?	**Would it be (at all) possible to** have something done?
Will you let this be done?	**Is it (at all) possible (for me/you) to** do something?
Can you do something?	**Is it (at all) possible to** have something done?
Will you allow me/you/someone to do something?	**Would you mind if** I did something?
Is it alright if I do something?	**Would you mind** doing something (for me)?
Do you mind doing something (for me)?	**I wonder if it is possible (for you)** to do something.
I want this. **Will you** do it?/**Can I** do it?	
Use would like / prefer / rather	
Do you want to try our new ice cream blend?	**Would you like to** try our new ice cream blend?
Here or there?	**Would you prefer to sit** here or there?
Which do you prefer? Waiting here for the results or having us call you back?	**Would you rather** wait for the results here or have us notify you?
Use single word verbs rather than phrasal verbs	
Hang on a second.	**Wait** a moment.
We were able to **talk him into** it.	We were able to **persuade/convince him**.
Use formal structures to convey negative messages	
You have to leave.	**I'm afraid** you **will** have to leave.
We can't authorize this.	**I'm sorry but** we cannot **give authorization for** this.
He died.	**I must regretfully inform you that** he has **passed away**.

See Appendix for Unit 4, pages 240-241 for an exercise on using appropriate register.

Pairwork. Take turns to make statements for the following situations and provide suitable responses in the correct register. You may use the Informal vs. Formal Language Box for guidance.

Student A asks student B:

1. (Student to peer) – Ask him/her to pass the salt at the cafeteria.

Pass me the salt please
or
Could you pass the salt

2. (Student to instructor) – Ask him/her to turn down the volume of the music.

Could you please turn down the volume a little

3. (Instructor to student) – Ask him/her to clarify his/her point.

Can you explain that
or
What do you mean exactly

4. (Manager to employee) – Remind him/her to visit the plant by noon tomorrow.

don't forget to visit the plant before noon tomorrow okay

5. (Assistant to manager) – Remind him/her of the meeting at 9:00 a.m. tomorrow.

Sir, I wanted to remind you that you have a meeting at 9:00 tomorrow

Student B asks student A:

1. (Secretary to applicant on the phone) – Inform him/her that his/her application has been rejected.

2. (Applicant to recruiter on the phone) – Ask him/her when to come in for an interview.

3. (Applicant to recruiter) - State your preference on taking the interview on Monday instead of Friday.

4. (Manager to employee) – State that you expected the work to have been completed by last Friday (but it wasn't).

5. (Employee to employee) – Tell him/her that the secretary probably went out for lunch. (It is 12:30p.m. now and she generally goes out for lunch at this time)

Put the conversation in order. Write the numbers from 1 to 10 in the space provided by looking at the general flow of a telephone conversation on page 131.

2 This is she.

9 That covers everything, thank you.

4 How can I help you, Mr. Watson?

1 Am I speaking to Terry Madison?

5 The reason I'm calling is to ask whether you'd be interested in taking part in a survey on teacher perceptions about cultural differences in the classroom.

10 You're welcome

8 Sure. Is there anything else?

6 I see. Sounds interesting. Why not?

3 My name is Dan Watson. I work at the Department of Education.

7 Oh great. I'll email the link to you.

Telephone phrases: Complete the conversations with the phrases from the Expressions for Making and Receiving Calls Box.

1. A: Hello. This is Ellen Morley. May I speak to Dr. Marlinsky?
   B: Yes, speaking.

2. A: Could I speak to Jeremy Evans from Technical Support, please?
   B: Sure. Please hold.

3. A: Good afternoon, Ms. Masters. How can I help you?
   B: The reason I'm calling is to ask you a question about the upcoming board meeting.

4. A: I'd like to speak to someone from Customer services, please.
   B: Certainly. I'll put you through.

5. A: Hello, is this Tech Support?
   B: No, sorry. Wrong number.

6. A: Good morning. Regency Publishing. Richard speaking. How can I help you?
   B: Hi, could you connect me to Mr. Wainwright's office, please.

Listening (Track 10)

Listen to the phone conversation and answer the questions.

Conversation 1

1. Why is the president's secretary calling?
2. What does the president want to talk about?
3. When will the Science Foundation call?

Conversation 2

1. Where is George? in his room
2. Why is Dana calling?
3. When will George go to the library?

Conversation 3

1. Why is Ted calling Kiki?
2. Why is it urgent?

III. Listening: (Track 13)

Listen to the telephone conversations and answer the questions below.

Conversation 1

1. The principal put Ted on speaker phone so that others could hear what he said.

2. What is the principal's email address? barton@newtown-ps.edu

Conversation 2:

1. What award has Ms. Applebee won? national children book award

2. When will the winner be announced? Next month

3. What is the email address? award2016@NCB.org

II. **Put the conversation in order. Write the numbers from 1 to 7 in the space provided.**

1 Can I speak with Elena Gomez, please?

5 That's right.

3 Yes. Could you tell her Barry called? Please ask him to call me back at 555 465 6700.

4 One moment, please... I'm sorry. There's no answer. Can I take a message?

2 Barry at 555 465 6700?

6 Is that all?

7 Yes, that's it. Thank you very much.

III. **Telephone phrases: Complete the messages with the most appropriate word(s) or phrases. Use the Expressions for Taking and Leaving Messages Box.**

1. Please ..Call.. Ms. Dougherty that I'll call back later.

2. Please ..give.. Mr. Barnes this message: Tomorrow's meeting has been postponed. I'll see him in the office tomorrow afternoon.

3. ..Could.. you please tell Mrs. Wells we have a dinner reservation for five at the Olive Garden tomorrow?

4. Inform Mr. Goran ..that.. the company driver will be picking him up at the airport upon arrival, please.

5. Please ..let.. her ..know.. that the conference will start at 10:00 a.m. İstanbul time.

6. I'm sorry. He is not available at the moment. ..Can I take/would you like.. a message?

7. I'm ..afraid.. she's not available at the moment. Would you like to call back later?

IV. Read the phone conversation. Check if the person has filled in the note pad correctly. Make corrections where necessary.

A: Hello. I'd like to speak with Mr. Lester Hammond, please.

B: One moment, please. I'll ring Mr. Hammond's office...I'm sorry, but there's no answer. Would you like to call back later?

A: No, I'd like to leave a message. Please tell him that Carol Yonge called. I'll be at 555-7759 until tomorrow night.

B: Ok, Ms. Carol ... is that Y-O-U...

A: No, it's Y-O, then N as in Norman, G as in George and E as in Echo.

B: OK, Ms. Yonge. I'll make sure he gets the message.

To: Carol Yonge

Date: 5/24 Time: 1945 a.m. / p.m.

MESSAGE FOR YOU

☑ Mr. / ☐ Ms. / ☐ Mrs. Lester Hammond

Phone: 555 7759
Area code Number Extension

☐ telephoned ☐ please call

☐ returned your call ☑ will call back

Message: She will be at the above number until tomorrow night

V. Listening: (Track 15)

Listen to the phone messages and complete each message slip, according to the information you hear.

1.

WHILE YOU WERE OUT...

DATE: _____ TIME: _____ a.m. / p.m.

FOR: Jessica Walsh

FROM: ☐ Mr. ☐ Ms.

Fabio

☐ Please call ☑ Will call again

☐ Wants to see you ☐ Returned your call

Message: that's ok

- Use formal language in business emails. Avoid slang, colloquialisms and abbreviations; therefore, a message written in appropriate tone and style is essential. Avoid flowery language and stick to the point as people do not want to spend time reading a message getting nowhere.

Spotlight on Writing Emails

Read the following email, underline the mistakes/problems and suggest corrections or ways to improve them.

Would it be possible to sign the new contract on Monday?

From janethegreat@BlueCo.mail.org ×

To davidrogers@abc.consulting.com ×

Cc ratkins@BlueCo.mail.org ×

Bcc Jeremy@home.co ×

Subject : Would it be possible to sign the new contract on Monday?

Hi,

We have mostly finalized the terms of the new contract with your company in our last meeting.

Since we consider it urgent to put the contract into effect, we would like to quickly arrange a meeting where the parties will sign the document.

We suggest Monday, April 22. Please inform us whether this is suitable for you.

Cheers,
Jane

Contracts Manager
BlueCo Incorporated
+11 555 789 7890

Sans Serif | B I U A | Send

Spotlight on Making Presentations

I. Put the presenter's introductory sentences in order. Write numbers from 1-7 in the spaces provided.

4 To begin with, I'd like to have a look at the performance of the company, the sales of the company over the last three years.

2 My name is Tim Mason, I'm a retail consultant.

3 I've invited you here today to share my findings about the company accounts.

1 Good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. Thank you for finding the time to come and join me for this presentation this afternoon.

6 And thirdly, I'd like to suggest some improvements in our range of womenswear.

7 At the end, I'd be happy to answer any of your questions.

5 Then, I'd like to have a look at our market share in the womenswear market and look at our competitors.

II. Put the statements from the concluding part of a presentation in order from 1-7.

6 In conclusion let me leave you with this thought: By calling attention to the problems and consequences of the decolonization of a country, many postcolonial writers and poets have raised awareness about the issues in their native countries and enlightened their people.

3 First, I examined Postcolonial literature briefly.

1 So, I have come to the end of my presentation.

4 Then we talked about Sri Lankan novelists in particular.

2 I'd like to recap the main points I have covered.

7 Now I'd like to invite any questions you may have.

5 And finally we scrutinized Michael Ondaatje's novel *Anil's Ghost* and focused on his criticism against oppression.

B. Read the rest of this meeting and answer the questions.

Francis Gilbert : Before I begin the report, I'd like to get some ideas from you all. How do you feel about rural sales in your sales districts? I suggest we go round the table first to get all of your input.

Fred Darcy : In my opinion, we have been focusing too much on rural customers and their needs. The way I see things, we need to return to our urban base by developing an advertising campaign to focus on their particular needs.

Pauline Dobbs : I'm afraid I can't agree with you. I think rural customers want to feel as important as our customers living in cities. I suggest we give our rural sales teams more help with advanced customer information reporting.

Dan Peters : Excuse me, I didn't catch that. Could you repeat that, please?

Pauline Dobbs : I just stated that we need to give our rural sales teams better customer information reporting.

Fred Darcy : I don't quite follow you. What exactly do you mean?

Pauline Dobbs : Well, we provide our city sales staff with database information on all of our larger clients. We should providing the same sort of knowledge on our rural customers to our sales staff there.

Francis Gilbert : Would you like to add anything, Paroma?

Paroma Patil : I must admit I never thought about rural sales that way before. I have to agree with Pauline.

Francis Gilbert : Well, let me begin with this Power Point presentation (Francis presents his report).
.... As you can see, we are developing new methods to reach out to our rural customers.

Fred Darcy : I suggest we break up into groups and discuss the ideas we've seen presented. ...

Chair : Unfortunately, we're running short of time. We'll have to leave that to another time.

Francis Gilbert : Before we close, let me just summarize the main points:
Rural customers need special help to feel more valued.
Our sales teams need more accurate information on our customers.
A survey will be completed to collect data on spending habits in these areas. The results of this su
will be
delivered to our sales teams
We are considering specific data mining procedures to help deepen our understanding.

Chair : Thank you very much Francis. Right, it looks as though we've covered the main items. Is there any o
business?

Donald Peters : Can we fix the next meeting, please?

Chair : Good idea Dan. How does Friday in two weeks' time sound to everyone? Let's meet at the same ti
9 o'clock. Is that OK for everyone? Excellent. I'd like to thank Francis for coming to our meeting tod
The meeting is closed.

Questions:

1. Underline the phrase in the meeting where the participant
   a. states disagreement
   b. asks for repetition
   c. asks for clarification

2. Put a tick next to each step that is covered in the closing of the meeting and underline the phrases used for each func
   - ☑ Signaling the end
   - ☑ Summarizing the main points
   - ☐ Introducing a new point
   - ☑ Deciding on the date and time of the next meeting
   - ☐ Asking for further suggestions or questions
   - ☐ Closing

3. In what ways do the participants contribute to the meeting?

meeting minutes

Spotlight on Meeting Language

A. Below is the opening of a sample meeting. Fill in the blanks with the suitable words from the list.

wrap up	attending	postpone	conference call	get started
item	commence	welcoming	agenda	
brainstorming	move on	overran	minutes	

Chair: If we are all here, let's (1) commence. As you all know, this meeting was supposed to (2) get started at 10:30 a.m.; however, we had to (3) postpone it to 11:30 a.m. as the previous meeting with the branch managers (4) overran by 45 minutes. First of all, I'd like you to please join me in (5) welcoming Francis Gilbert, our Southwest Area Sales Vice President.

Francis Gilbert: Thank you for having me, I'm looking forward to today's meeting.

Chair: Well, I'm afraid our national sales director, Elizabeth Bennet, won't be (6) attending the meeting today. She is in Xiamen at the moment, developing our Far East sales force. However, she will inform us of the developments through a (7) conference call on Friday's meeting. We're here today to discuss ways of improving sales in rural market areas. First, let's go over the (8) minutes of the last meeting which was held on June 24th. Right, Tristan. Over to you.

Tristan Pitt: Thank you Lance. Let me just summarize the main points of the last meeting. We began the meeting by approving the changes in our sales reporting system discussed on May 30th. After briefly revising the changes that will take place, we moved on to a (9) brainstorming session concerning after sales customer support improvements. You'll find a copy of the main ideas developed and discussed in these sessions in the photocopies in front of you.

Chair: Thank you, Tristan. I'd like to (10) wrap up this meeting at around 12:30 so that we don't skip our lunch break. So, if there is nothing else we need to discuss, let's move on to today's (11) agenda. Have you all received a copy of it? If you don't mind, I'd like to skip (12) item number one and (13) move on to the second one: Sales improvement in rural market areas. Francis has kindly agreed to give us a report on this matter. Francis?

Rimeysa